

Homework 9, Week 11

Activity 1

ACTIVITY 1



Examine the following arguments. First identify the claims and the support, and then put forward counterarguments (if possible, including rebutting and undercutting arguments).

1. Freud was a real cultural innovator, for he changed forever the way humans see themselves.
2. Alcohol drunk to excess impairs judgment of time and distance. Up to 75% of fatal road accidents involve alcohol. Drinking alcohol is an anti-social habit.
3. Smoking is bad for your health, because it destroys the healthy functioning of your lungs. Anything that destroys the healthy functioning of your lungs is bad for your health.
4. Euthanasia leads to a loss of respect for human life. Anything that leads to a loss of respect for human life is dangerous. Therefore, euthanasia is dangerous.
5. Punishment does not deter crime unless it is swift and certain. Punishment is not swift and certain in the North American justice system. Therefore, punishment does not deter crime in the North American justice system.
6. The Netherlands is susceptible to flooding. What evidence do we have to support that claim? The Netherlands is below sea level in many areas, and any area below sea level is susceptible to flooding. The reason is that water always exerts pressure on whatever contains it. If released, it flows downward to occupy an empty space.
7. Climate is complicated and there are lots of competing theories and unsolved mysteries. Until this is all worked out, one cannot claim there is consensus on global warming. Until there is, we should not take any action.
8. A direct relationship has more or less been proven between massive energy consumption (primarily of fossil fuels) and growth in the economy and welfare of a country. My personal energy requirement is modest. I won't change before the big polluters have changed their behavior.

1. "Freud was a real cultural innovator" is the claim and the latter is the support.
2. The last sentence is the claim and the former sentences are the supports.
3. "Smoking is bad for your health" is the claim and the latter sentences is the supports.
4. The last sentence is the claim and the former sentences are the supports.

5. The last sentence is the claim and the former sentences are the supports. And it is the rebutting arguments.
 6. The first sentence is the claim and the latter sentences are the supports.
 7. The first sentence is the claim and the latter sentences are the supports.
 8. The first sentence is the claim and the latter sentences are the supports.
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Essay 2

Destructiveness of Man

George P. Marsh

“Not all the winds, and storms, and earthquakes, and seas, and seasons of the world, have done so much to revolutionize the earth as MAN, the power of an endless life, has done since the day he came forth upon it, and received dominion over it.” —H. Bushnell, *Sermon on the Power of an Endless Life* (**Cite the words of the professor to prove the disasters generated by man**)

1. Man has too long forgotten that the Earth was given to him for usufruct alone, not for consumption, still less for profligate waste. Nature has provided against the absolute destruction of any of her elementary matter, the raw material of her works; the thunderbolt and the tornado, the most convulsive throes of even the volcano and the earthquake, being only phenomena of decomposition and recomposition. But she has left it within the power of man irreparably to derange the combinations of inorganic matter and of organic life, which through the night of aeons she had been proportioning and balancing, to prepare the Earth for his habitation, when in the fullness of time his Creator should call him forth to enter into its possession. (**The earth gives the necessary resources for a long time to man but man has forgotten it**)
2. Apart from the hostile influence of man, the organic and the inorganic world are, as I have remarked, bound together by such mutual relations and adaptations as secure, if not the absolute permanence and equilibrium of both, a long continuance of the established conditions of each at any given time and place, or at least, a very slow and gradual succession of changes in those conditions. But man is everywhere a disturbing agent. Wherever he plants his foot, the harmonies of nature are turned to discords. The proportions and accommodations which insured the stability of existing arrangements are overthrown. Indigenous vegetable and animal species are extirpated, and supplanted by others of foreign origin, spontaneous production is forbidden or restricted, and the face of the Earth is either laid bare or covered with a new and reluctant growth of vegetable forms,

and with alien **tribes** of animal life. These intentional changes and substitutions constitute, indeed, great revolutions; but vast as is their magnitude and importance, they are, as we shall see, insignificant in comparison with the **contingent** and unsought results which have flowed from them. ***(Human breaks down the balance between the organic and inorganic world)***

3. The fact that, of all organic beings, man alone is to be regarded as essentially a destructive power, and that he **wields** energies to resist which Nature—that nature whom all material life and all inorganic substance obey—is wholly **impotent**, tends to prove that, though living in physical nature, he is not of her, that he is of more **exalted** parentage, and belongs to a higher order of existences, than those which are born from her **womb** and live in blind submission to her dictates. ***(Argue that the man is the only essentially destructive among all organic beings and are proud of it)***
4. There are, indeed, brute destroyers, beasts and birds and insects of prey—all animal life feeds upon, and, of course, destroys other life,—but this destruction is balanced by compensations. It is, in fact, the very means by which the existence of one tribe of animals or of vegetables is secured against being **smothered** by the **encroachments** of another; and the reproductive powers of species, which serve as the food of others, are always proportioned to the demand they are destined to supply. Man pursues his victims with reckless destructiveness; and, while the sacrifice of life by the lower animals is limited by the **cravings** of appetite, he **unsparingly persecutes**, even to extirpation, thousands of organic forms which he cannot consume. ***(State that the other organic lives forms a bond to balance the destruction of human)***
5. The Earth was not, in its natural condition, completely adapted to the use of man, but only to the sustenance of wild animals and wild vegetation. These live, multiply their kind in just proportion, and attain their perfect measure of strength and beauty, without producing or requiring any important change in the natural arrangements of surface, or in each other's spontaneous tendencies, except such mutual **repression** of excessive increase as may prevent the extirpation of one species by the encroachments of another. In short, without man, lower animal and spontaneous vegetable life would have been practically constant in type, distribution and proportion, and the physical geography of the Earth would have remained undisturbed for indefinite periods, and been subject to revolution only from slow development, from possible, unknown **cosmical** causes, or from geological action. ***(Utter that without man the earth and the other organic lives will keep balance and remained undisturbed)***
6. But man, the domestic animals that serve him, the field and garden plants the products of which supply him with food and clothing, cannot **subsist** and rise to the full development of their higher properties, unless brutal and unconscious nature can be effectually combated, and, to a great degree, **vanquished** by human art. Hence, a certain measure of transformation of **terrestrial** surface, of **suppression** of natural, and stimulation of artificially modified productivity becomes necessary. This measure man has unfortunately exceeded.

He has felled the forests whose network of fibrous roots bound the mould to the rocky skeleton of the earth; but had he allowed here and there a belt of woodland to reproduce itself by spontaneous **propagation**, most of the **mischief** which his reckless destruction of the natural protection of the soil has occasioned would have been **averted**. He has broken up mountain **reservoirs**, the **percolation** of whose waters through unseen channels supplied fountains that refreshed his cattle and fertilized his fields; but he has neglected to maintain the **cisterns** and the canals of irrigation which a wise **antiquity** had constructed to neutralize the consequences of its own **imprudence**. While he has torn the thin **glebe** which confined the light earth of extensive plains, and has destroyed the **fringe** of semi-aquatic plants which skirted the coast and checked the drifting of the sea sand, he has failed to prevent the spreading of the **dunes** by clothing them with artificially propagated vegetation. He has **ruthlessly** warred on all the tribes of animated nature whose spoil he could convert to his own uses, and he has not protected the birds which **prey** on the insects most destructive to his own harvests. ***(Man exceeded the limit of modifying productivity of nature and lead to some disasters)***

7. Purely untutored humanity, it is true, interferes comparatively little with the arrangements of nature, and the destructive agency of man becomes more and more energetic and unsparing as he advances in civilization, until the **impoverishment** with which his exhaustion of the natural resources of the soil is threatening him, at last awakens him to the necessity of preserving what is left, if not of restoring what has been wantonly wasted. The wandering **savage** grows no cultivated vegetable, fells no forest, and extirpates no useful plant, no **noxious** weed. If his skill in the chase enables him to entrap numbers of the animals on which he feeds, he compensates this loss by destroying also the lion, the tiger, the wolf, the otter, the seal, and the eagle, thus indirectly protecting the **feebler quadrupeds** and fish and **fowls**, which would otherwise become the booty of beasts and birds of prey. But with stationary life, or at latest with the pastoral state, man at once commences an almost indiscriminate warfare upon all the forms of animal and vegetable existence around him, and as he advances in civilization, he gradually **eradicates** or transforms every spontaneous product of the soil he occupies. ***(The degree of nature been destructive is related to the degree of civilization of human)***

Significant Words and Phrases

- usufruct
the right of usage
- profligate
without limit

- convulsive
suddenly shaky
- throe
ache
- irreparably
impossibly to repair
- aeon
a billion years
- equilibrium
balance
- indigenous #CET6
local
- extirpate
destroy
- spontaneous #CET4 #CET6
without apparent cause
- tribe #CET6
a group
- contingent #CET6
a gathering of persons
- wield #CET6
use
- impotent
without power
- exalted
advanced
- womb
the organ to cultivate babies
- smother
restrain
- encroachment
invasion
- craving #CET6
intense desire
- unsparingly
strictly
- persecute #CET6
destroy; cause to suffer

- repression #CET6
restrain
- cosmical
universal
- subsist
exist
- vanquish
conquer
- terrestrial
living on the land; global
- suppression #CET6
refrain
- propagation #CET6
spread; breeding
- mischief
trick
- avert #CET6
avoid
- reservoir #CET6
the storage of water
- percolation
filter
- cistern
box holding water
- antiquity
ancient era
- imprudence
rude behaviours
- glebe
land
- fringe #CET6
edge
- dune
a pile of dust and sand
- ruthlessly
cruelly
- prey #CET6
take something hunted

- impoverishment
poverty
 - savage #CET6
fierce
 - noxious
harmful
 - feebler
faint
 - quadruped
animals with four feet
 - fowl
the birds
 - eradicate #CET6
kill; destroy
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Topic Idea

This essay emphasizes the positive destruction of nature brought by human and states in detail the aspects been destroyed.

Activity 7

ACTIVITY 7

Read the essay, critically considering its writing techniques, and discuss the following questions in groups of three or four.

1. What are the main arguments regarding the destructiveness of human beings in their relationship with Nature? Do you agree or disagree with these arguments? Why?
2. Are you satisfied with the steps in Marsh's reasoning in supporting the claim that "of all organic beings, man alone is to be regarded as essentially a destructive power" (Para. 3)? If yes, can you provide more examples to support his reasoning? If not, what would you change or add to improve the reasoning?
3. What kind of evidence does Marsh use to support his reasoning? Is the evidence relevant and sufficient? Why or why not?
4. According to Marsh, animals are also mutual destroyers but such destruction is different from that caused by human beings. In what way is this argument related to the main argument of the destructiveness of human beings in their relationship with Nature?

1. "Man has too long forgotten that the Earth was given to him for usufruct alone, not for consumption, still less for profligate waste" "But man is everywhere a disturbing agent" "of all organic beings, man alone is to be regarded as essentially a destructive power" "thousands of organic forms which he cannot consume", the last sentence of paragraph 5 and so on. I agree with these arguments since it deeply analyze the details of the destructiveness of man to the nature.
2. I am satisfied with the steps. Humanity always takes some precious natural resources as their representation of luxury and gains them by destroying the nature.
3. The evidence are the detailed data, fact, the citation of the words of other professor. It is relevant and sufficient since they support the claim from different aspects and make the claim more convincing and strengthen the reality.
4. The destruction of animals aims to contrast with the destruction with humanity and emphasize the main argument of destructiveness of human beings with nature.

Exercise 4(3)

Your position:

I agree that the global warming is human-made.

How you would argue for your position:

I will contrast the specific data of the naturally increase with the odd increase contributed to

humanity. And illustrate the facts of human's measures leading to the global warming. Also cite other authorized words and data to support my position.